MSDS_422_Final_Project

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1 Predicting 30-Day Hospital Readmission for Diabetic Patients

1.1 MSDS 422: Practical Machine Learning — Final Project

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1.1.1 Project Overview

This notebook implements an end-to-end machine learning pipeline for predicting whether a diabetic patient will be readmitted to the hospital within 30 days of discharge. We use the **UCI Diabetes 130-US Hospitals Dataset** (101,766 encounters, 55 features) and compare four modeling approaches:

1. **Logistic Regression** — interpretable baseline with L2 regularization
2. **Random Forest** — ensemble method capturing nonlinear interactions
3. **XGBoost** — gradient boosting (expected best performer per Emi-Johnson & Nkrumah, 2025)
4. **MLP Neural Network** — deep learning for complex pattern detection

The 11.2% positive class rate (readmitted <30 days) creates a 7.2:1 class imbalance, making AUC-ROC our primary evaluation metric. Our feature engineering focuses on prior healthcare utilization patterns, which the literature identifies as the strongest readmission predictors (Dugan & Shubrook, 2020).

Framework: CRISP-DM
Tooling: Python 3.10, Google Colab (NVIDIA T4 GPU), scikit-learn, XGBoost
Repository: github.com/abdullahabdulsami2026-coder/MSDS422_Final_Project

1.2 1. Environment Setup and Imports

All dependencies are loaded here once. We use scikit-learn for modeling and evaluation, XGBoost for gradient boosting, and matplotlib/seaborn for visualization. The warnings filter suppresses convergence messages during hyperparameter search.

[1]:
```
import os
import json
import warnings
```

```python
import numpy as np
import pandas as pd
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns
from scipy import stats

from sklearn.model_selection import (
    train_test_split, StratifiedKFold, GridSearchCV,
    RandomizedSearchCV, cross_val_predict
)
from sklearn.preprocessing import StandardScaler, LabelEncoder
from sklearn.linear_model import LogisticRegression
from sklearn.ensemble import RandomForestClassifier
from sklearn.neural_network import MLPClassifier
from sklearn.metrics import (
    roc_auc_score, precision_score, recall_score, f1_score,
    accuracy_score, confusion_matrix, classification_report,
    roc_curve, precision_recall_curve, average_precision_score
)
import joblib

try:
    import xgboost as xgb
    print(f"XGBoost version: {xgb.__version__}")
except ImportError:
    !pip install xgboost -q
    import xgboost as xgb

warnings.filterwarnings("ignore")
sns.set_style("whitegrid")
plt.rcParams["figure.dpi"] = 150
plt.rcParams["font.size"] = 11

RANDOM_STATE = 42
N_FOLDS = 5
DATA_PATH = r"C:\STUDY\MSDS422\Final\diabetic_data.csv"

print("All libraries loaded successfully.")
print(f"Data path: {DATA_PATH}")
```

```
All libraries loaded successfully.
Data path: C:\STUDY\MSDS422\Final\diabetic_data.csv
```

1.3 2. Data Loading and Initial Inspection

The UCI Diabetes 130-US Hospitals dataset contains 101,766 inpatient encounters from 130 hospitals (1999–2008). Question marks in the raw CSV represent missing values. We examine the shape, data types, missing value counts, and target variable distribution before any preprocessing.

[2]:
```
# Load raw data - question marks are missing values
df_raw = pd.read_csv(DATA_PATH, na_values="?")

print(f"Dataset shape: {df_raw.shape}")
print(f"Encounters: {len(df_raw):,}")
print(f"Features: {df_raw.shape[1]}")
print(f"\nMemory usage: {df_raw.memory_usage(deep=True).sum() / 1e6:.1f} MB")
print(f"\nData types:\n{df_raw.dtypes.value_counts()}")

print(f"\nTarget variable distribution:")
print(df_raw["readmitted"].value_counts())
print(f"\nReadmission <30 days rate: {(df_raw['readmitted'] == '<30').mean():.
↪1%}")
```

```
Dataset shape: (101766, 50)
Encounters: 101,766
Features: 50

Memory usage: 198.8 MB

Data types:
object    37
int64     13
Name: count, dtype: int64

Target variable distribution:
readmitted
NO     54864
>30    35545
<30    11357
Name: count, dtype: int64

Readmission <30 days rate: 11.2%
```

[3]:
```
# First 5 rows
df_raw.head()
```

[3]:
```
   encounter_id  patient_nbr             race  gender      age weight  \
0       2278392      8222157        Caucasian  Female   [0-10)    NaN
1        149190     55629189        Caucasian  Female  [10-20)    NaN
2         64410     86047875  AfricanAmerican  Female  [20-30)    NaN
3        500364     82442376        Caucasian    Male  [30-40)    NaN
4         16680     42519267        Caucasian    Male  [40-50)    NaN

   admission_type_id  discharge_disposition_id  admission_source_id  \
0                  6                        25                    1
1                  1                         1                    7
2                  1                         1                    7
```

```
3                  1                          1                     7
4                  1                          1                     7

   time_in_hospital  … citoglipton insulin  glyburide-metformin  \
0                 1  …          No      No                   No
1                 3  …          No      Up                   No
2                 2  …          No      No                   No
3                 2  …          No      Up                   No
4                 1  …          No  Steady                   No

   glipizide-metformin  glimepiride-pioglitazone  metformin-rosiglitazone  \
0                   No                         No                       No
1                   No                         No                       No
2                   No                         No                       No
3                   No                         No                       No
4                   No                         No                       No

   metformin-pioglitazone  change diabetesMed readmitted
0                      No      No          No         NO
1                      No      Ch         Yes        >30
2                      No      No         Yes         NO
3                      No      Ch         Yes         NO
4                      No      Ch         Yes         NO

[5 rows x 50 columns]
```

[4]:
```python
# Column overview
df_raw.info(verbose=True, show_counts=True)
```

```
<class 'pandas.core.frame.DataFrame'>
RangeIndex: 101766 entries, 0 to 101765
Data columns (total 50 columns):
 #   Column                    Non-Null Count   Dtype
---  ------                    --------------   -----
 0   encounter_id              101766 non-null  int64
 1   patient_nbr               101766 non-null  int64
 2   race                      99493 non-null   object
 3   gender                    101766 non-null  object
 4   age                       101766 non-null  object
 5   weight                    3197 non-null    object
 6   admission_type_id         101766 non-null  int64
 7   discharge_disposition_id  101766 non-null  int64
 8   admission_source_id       101766 non-null  int64
 9   time_in_hospital          101766 non-null  int64
 10  payer_code                61510 non-null   object
 11  medical_specialty         51817 non-null   object
 12  num_lab_procedures        101766 non-null  int64
 13  num_procedures            101766 non-null  int64
```

```
 14  num_medications           101766 non-null  int64
 15  number_outpatient         101766 non-null  int64
 16  number_emergency          101766 non-null  int64
 17  number_inpatient          101766 non-null  int64
 18  diag_1                    101745 non-null  object
 19  diag_2                    101408 non-null  object
 20  diag_3                    100343 non-null  object
 21  number_diagnoses          101766 non-null  int64
 22  max_glu_serum             5346 non-null    object
 23  A1Cresult                 17018 non-null   object
 24  metformin                 101766 non-null  object
 25  repaglinide               101766 non-null  object
 26  nateglinide               101766 non-null  object
 27  chlorpropamide            101766 non-null  object
 28  glimepiride               101766 non-null  object
 29  acetohexamide             101766 non-null  object
 30  glipizide                 101766 non-null  object
 31  glyburide                 101766 non-null  object
 32  tolbutamide               101766 non-null  object
 33  pioglitazone              101766 non-null  object
 34  rosiglitazone             101766 non-null  object
 35  acarbose                  101766 non-null  object
 36  miglitol                  101766 non-null  object
 37  troglitazone              101766 non-null  object
 38  tolazamide                101766 non-null  object
 39  examide                   101766 non-null  object
 40  citoglipton               101766 non-null  object
 41  insulin                   101766 non-null  object
 42  glyburide-metformin       101766 non-null  object
 43  glipizide-metformin       101766 non-null  object
 44  glimepiride-pioglitazone  101766 non-null  object
 45  metformin-rosiglitazone   101766 non-null  object
 46  metformin-pioglitazone    101766 non-null  object
 47  change                    101766 non-null  object
 48  diabetesMed               101766 non-null  object
 49  readmitted                101766 non-null  object
dtypes: int64(13), object(37)
memory usage: 38.8+ MB
```

1.4 3. Exploratory Data Analysis

Before modeling, we conduct a thorough EDA to understand data quality, feature distributions, and patterns relevant to readmission prediction. This informs our feature engineering and modeling decisions.

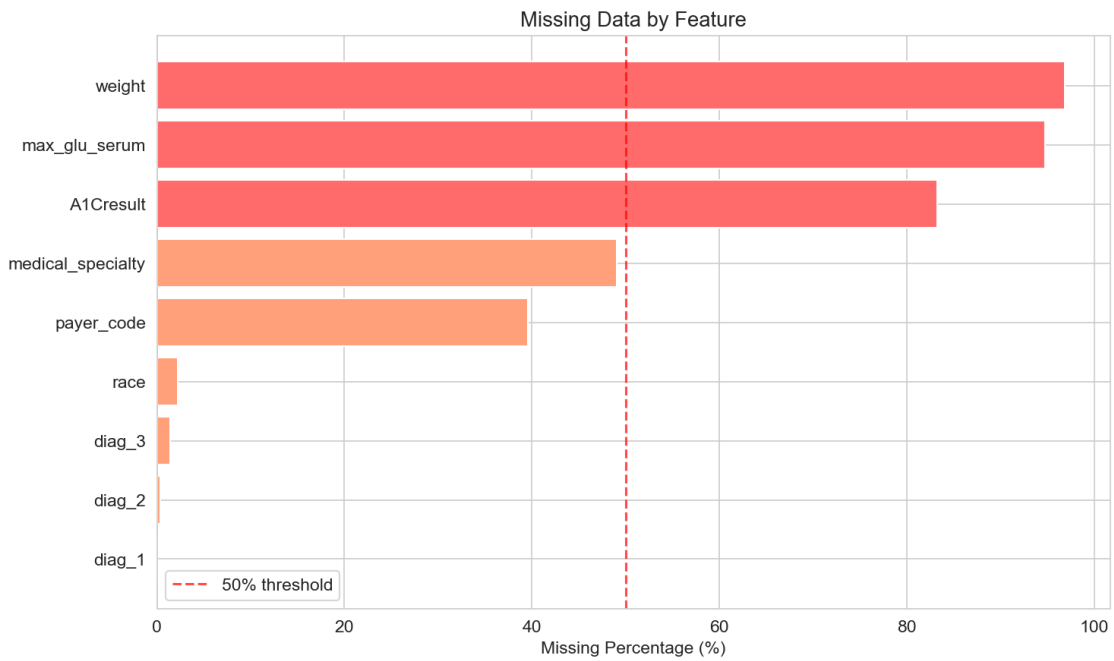
1.4.1 3.1 Missing Data Analysis

Understanding the missing data pattern is critical. Some variables have clinically meaningful missingness — for example, the absence of an HbA1c or glucose test indicates the test was not ordered, which itself may reflect clinical judgment about the patient's severity.

[5]:
```
# Missing data analysis
missing = df_raw.isnull().sum()
missing_pct = (missing / len(df_raw) * 100).sort_values(ascending=False)
missing_features = missing_pct[missing_pct > 0]

print("Features with missing values:")
print(missing_features.to_string())

# Missing data visualization
fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(10, 6))
colors = ["#ff6b6b" if v > 50 else "#ffa07a" for v in missing_features.values]
bars = ax.barh(range(len(missing_features)), missing_features.values,␣
↪color=colors)
ax.set_yticks(range(len(missing_features)))
ax.set_yticklabels(missing_features.index)
ax.set_xlabel("Missing Percentage (%)")
ax.set_title("Missing Data by Feature")
ax.axvline(x=50, color="red", linestyle="--", alpha=0.7, label="50% threshold")
ax.legend()
ax.invert_yaxis()
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("01_missing_data_analysis.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()

print(f"\nDecisions:")
print(f"  DROP: weight ({missing_pct.get('weight', 0):.0f}% missing) -␣
↪imputation unreliable")
print(f"  DROP: payer_code ({missing_pct.get('payer_code', 0):.0f}% missing)")
print(f"  KEEP: medical_specialty ({missing_pct.get('medical_specialty', 0):.
↪0f}% missing) - fill with 'Unknown'")
print(f"  KEEP: race ({missing_pct.get('race', 0):.0f}% missing) - impute with␣
↪mode")
print(f"  KEEP: A1Cresult, max_glu_serum - 'None' is clinically meaningful␣
↪(test not ordered)")
```

```
Features with missing values:
weight               96.858479
max_glu_serum        94.746772
A1Cresult            83.277322
medical_specialty    49.082208
payer_code           39.557416
race                  2.233555
```

```
diag_3                 1.398306
diag_2                 0.351787
diag_1                 0.020636
```



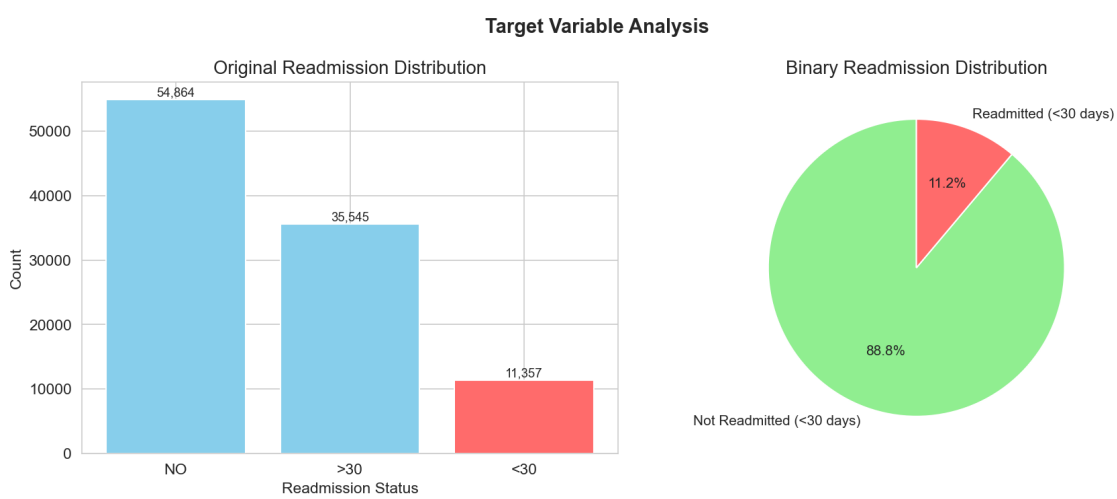

```
Decisions:
  DROP: weight (97% missing) - imputation unreliable
  DROP: payer_code (40% missing)
  KEEP: medical_specialty (49% missing) - fill with 'Unknown'
  KEEP: race (2% missing) - impute with mode
  KEEP: A1Cresult, max_glu_serum - 'None' is clinically meaningful (test not
ordered)
```

1.4.2 3.2 Target Variable Distribution

The target variable has three original categories: no readmission, readmission after 30 days, and readmission within 30 days. We convert this to binary (readmitted <30 days = 1, otherwise = 0). The resulting 11.2% positive class rate creates a significant 7.2:1 imbalance that must be addressed during modeling.

[6]:
```
# Target distribution
fig, axes = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(12, 5))

# Original 3-category
counts = df_raw["readmitted"].value_counts()
```

```
axes[0].bar(counts.index, counts.values, color=["#87CEEB", "#87CEEB",␣
↪"#FF6B6B"])
axes[0].set_title("Original Readmission Distribution")
axes[0].set_xlabel("Readmission Status")
axes[0].set_ylabel("Count")
for i, (idx, val) in enumerate(zip(counts.index, counts.values)):
    axes[0].text(i, val + 500, f"{val:,}", ha="center", fontsize=9)

# Binary
readmit_binary = (df_raw["readmitted"] == "<30").astype(int)
binary_counts = readmit_binary.value_counts()
labels = ["Not Readmitted (<30 days)", "Readmitted (<30 days)"]
colors_pie = ["#90EE90", "#FF6B6B"]
axes[1].pie(binary_counts.values, labels=labels, colors=colors_pie,
            autopct="%1.1f%%", startangle=90, textprops={"fontsize": 10})
axes[1].set_title("Binary Readmission Distribution")

plt.suptitle("Target Variable Analysis", fontsize=14, fontweight="bold")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("02_target_distribution.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()

pos_rate = readmit_binary.mean()
print(f"Positive class (readmitted <30 days): {readmit_binary.sum():,}␣
↪({pos_rate:.1%})")
print(f"Negative class: {(1 - readmit_binary).sum():,} ({1 - pos_rate:.1%})")
print(f"Imbalance ratio: {(1 - pos_rate) / pos_rate:.1f}:1")
```



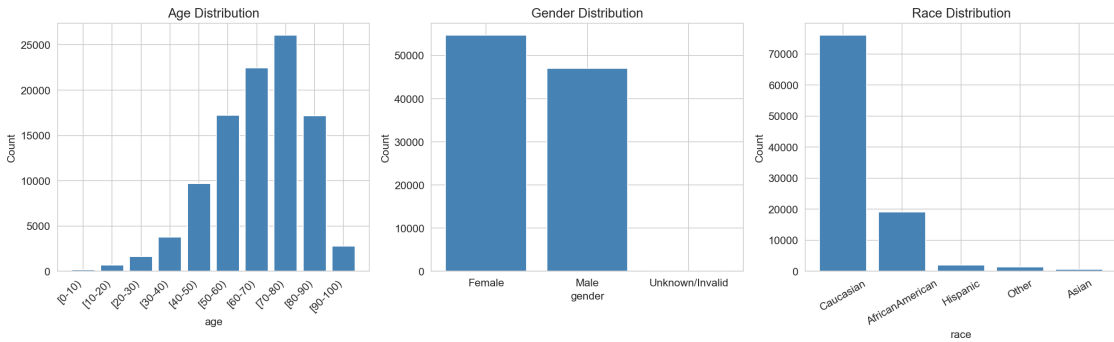

```
Positive class (readmitted <30 days): 11,357 (11.2%)
Negative class: 90,409 (88.8%)
```

```
Imbalance ratio: 8.0:1
```

1.4.3 3.3 Demographic Distributions

We examine age, gender, and race distributions to understand the patient population. The dataset skews older (peak at 70–80), is roughly gender-balanced, and is predominantly Caucasian — all factors to consider when interpreting model generalizability.

[7]:
```
# Demographics
fig, axes = plt.subplots(1, 3, figsize=(16, 5))

# Age
age_order = ["[0-10)", "[10-20)", "[20-30)", "[30-40)", "[40-50)",
             "[50-60)", "[60-70)", "[70-80)", "[80-90)", "[90-100)"]
age_counts = df_raw["age"].value_counts().reindex(age_order)
axes[0].bar(range(len(age_counts)), age_counts.values, color="#4682B4")
axes[0].set_xticks(range(len(age_counts)))
axes[0].set_xticklabels(age_counts.index, rotation=45, ha="right")
axes[0].set_title("Age Distribution")
axes[0].set_ylabel("Count")
axes[0].set_xlabel("age")

# Gender
gender_counts = df_raw["gender"].value_counts()
axes[1].bar(gender_counts.index, gender_counts.values, color="#4682B4")
axes[1].set_title("Gender Distribution")
axes[1].set_ylabel("Count")
axes[1].set_xlabel("gender")

# Race
race_counts = df_raw["race"].value_counts()
axes[2].bar(race_counts.index, race_counts.values, color="#4682B4")
axes[2].set_title("Race Distribution")
axes[2].set_ylabel("Count")
axes[2].set_xlabel("race")
axes[2].tick_params(axis="x", rotation=30)

plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("03_demographics.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()

print(f"Age peak: {age_counts.idxmax()} ({age_counts.max():,} encounters)")
print(f"Gender split: Female {gender_counts.get('Female', 0):,}, Male␣
↪{gender_counts.get('Male', 0):,}")
print(f"Race: {race_counts.index[0]} dominant ({race_counts.iloc[0]:,},␣
↪{race_counts.iloc[0]/len(df_raw):.0%})")
```



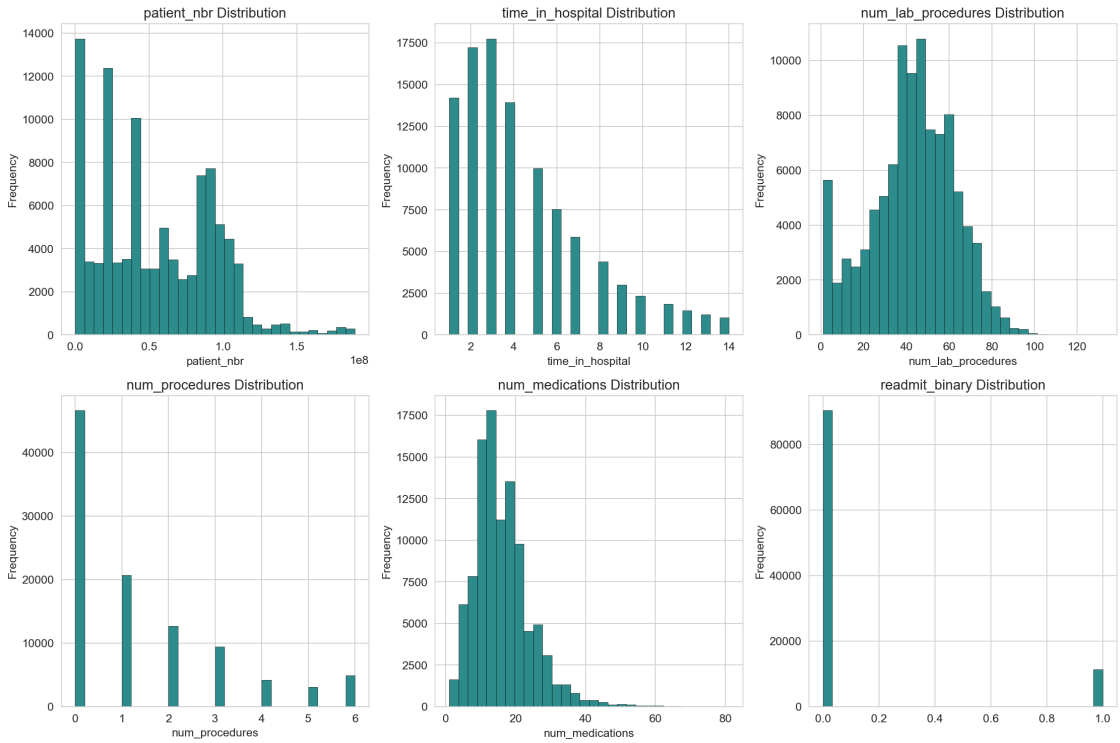

```
Age peak: [70-80) (26,068 encounters)
Gender split: Female 54,708, Male 47,055
Race: Caucasian dominant (76,099, 75%)
```

1.4.4 3.4 Continuous Feature Distributions

Key clinical metrics show right-skewed distributions typical of healthcare data. Most hospital stays are 1–4 days, lab procedures center around 40–50, and the number of medications peaks at 10–20. Many encounters have zero procedures, indicating non-surgical admissions.

[8]:
```
# Continuous features
cont_features = ["patient_nbr", "time_in_hospital", "num_lab_procedures",
                 "num_procedures", "num_medications", "readmit_binary"]

# Add binary target temporarily for plotting
df_plot = df_raw.copy()
df_plot["readmit_binary"] = (df_plot["readmitted"] == "<30").astype(int)

fig, axes = plt.subplots(2, 3, figsize=(15, 10))
axes = axes.flatten()

for i, col in enumerate(cont_features):
    if col in df_plot.columns:
        axes[i].hist(df_plot[col].dropna(), bins=30, color="#2E8B8B",␣
 ↪edgecolor="black", linewidth=0.3)
        axes[i].set_title(f"{col} Distribution")
        axes[i].set_xlabel(col if col != "readmit_binary" else "")
        axes[i].set_ylabel("Frequency")

plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("04_continuous_distributions.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()

# Summary stats for key clinical features
print("Key clinical feature statistics:")
```

```
for col in ["time_in_hospital", "num_lab_procedures", "num_procedures",␣
↪"num_medications"]:
    print(f"  {col}: mean={df_raw[col].mean():.1f}, median={df_raw[col].
↪median():.1f}, std={df_raw[col].std():.1f}")
```



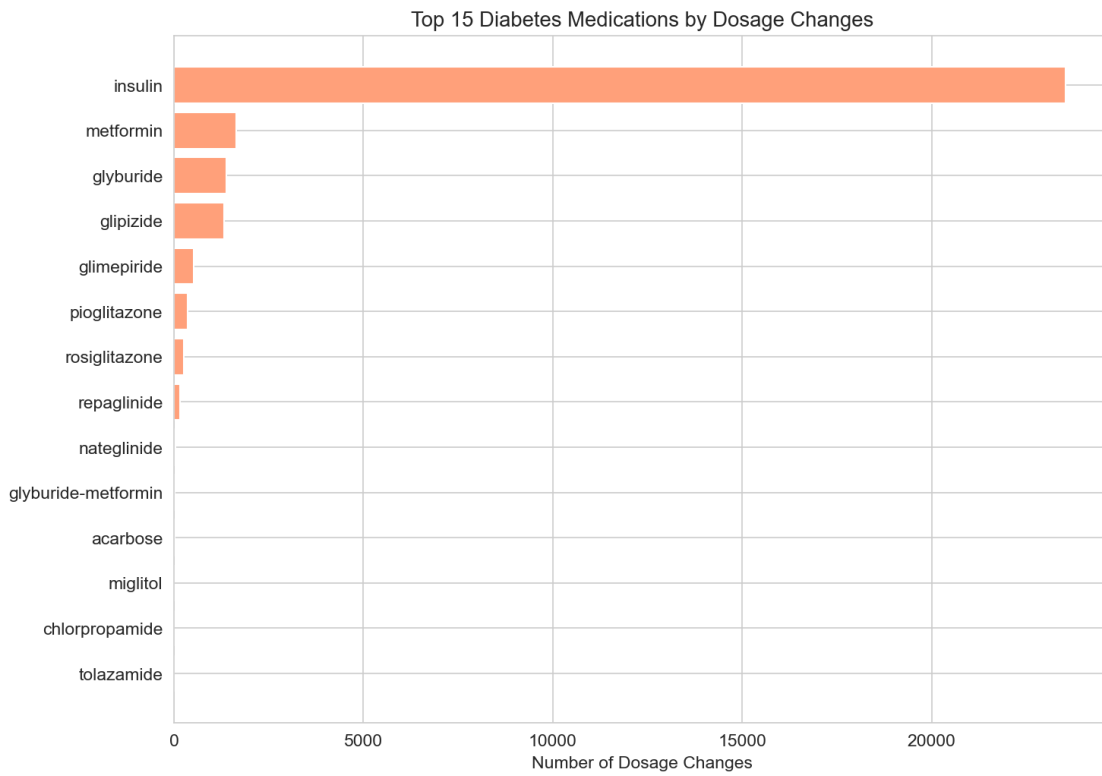

```
Key clinical feature statistics:
  time_in_hospital: mean=4.4, median=4.0, std=3.0
  num_lab_procedures: mean=43.1, median=44.0, std=19.7
  num_procedures: mean=1.3, median=1.0, std=1.7
  num_medications: mean=16.0, median=15.0, std=8.1
```

1.4.5 3.5 Medication Dosage Changes

Insulin dominates medication changes with over 22,000 dosage modifications — far exceeding all other medications combined. This concentration suggests insulin management is the primary pharmacological lever being adjusted during hospitalization, and changes to insulin dosing may signal glycemic instability associated with readmission risk.

[9]:
```
# Medication changes analysis
med_columns = [
    "metformin", "repaglinide", "nateglinide", "chlorpropamide",
    "glimepiride", "acetohexamide", "glipizide", "glyburide",
    "tolbutamide", "pioglitazone", "rosiglitazone", "acarbose",
    "miglitol", "troglitazone", "tolazamide", "insulin",
```

```
    "glyburide-metformin", "glipizide-metformin",
    "glimepiride-pioglitazone", "metformin-rosiglitazone",
    "metformin-pioglitazone"
]

# Count dosage changes (anything other than "No" or "Steady")
med_changes = {}
for col in med_columns:
    if col in df_raw.columns:
        changes = df_raw[col].isin(["Up", "Down"]).sum()
        if changes > 0:
            med_changes[col] = changes

med_df = pd.Series(med_changes).sort_values(ascending=True).tail(15)

fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(10, 7))
ax.barh(range(len(med_df)), med_df.values, color="#FFA07A")
ax.set_yticks(range(len(med_df)))
ax.set_yticklabels(med_df.index)
ax.set_xlabel("Number of Dosage Changes")
ax.set_title("Top 15 Diabetes Medications by Dosage Changes")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("05_medication_changes.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()

print(f"Insulin dosage changes: {med_changes.get('insulin', 0):,}")
print(f"Metformin dosage changes: {med_changes.get('metformin', 0):,}")
print(f"Insulin accounts for {med_changes.get('insulin', 0) / sum(med_changes.
 ↪values()):.0%} of all medication changes")
```




```
Insulin dosage changes: 23,534
Metformin dosage changes: 1,642
Insulin accounts for 80% of all medication changes
```

1.5 4. Data Cleaning and Preprocessing

We apply a systematic cleaning pipeline to prepare the data for modeling:

1. **Deduplicate** by patient (keep first encounter per patient_nbr) to prevent data leakage
2. **Remove invalid discharges** — patients who died or were discharged to hospice are not readmission candidates
3. **Drop high-missingness columns** — weight (97%), payer_code (52%)
4. **Create binary target** — readmitted <30 days = 1, otherwise = 0
5. **Handle remaining missing values** — mode for categorical, median for numeric

[10]:
```
# ============================================================
# DATA CLEANING PIPELINE
# ============================================================
df = df_raw.copy()
print(f"Starting shape: {df.shape}")

# Step 1: Deduplicate - keep first encounter per patient
```

```
df = df.sort_values("encounter_id").drop_duplicates(subset=["patient_nbr"],␣
↪keep="first")
print(f"After dedup (first encounter per patient): {df.shape[0]:,} (removed␣
↪{len(df_raw) - len(df):,})")

# Step 2: Remove invalid discharges (deceased, hospice)
invalid_discharges = [11, 13, 14, 19, 20, 21]
before = len(df)
df = df[~df["discharge_disposition_id"].isin(invalid_discharges)]
print(f"After removing deceased/hospice discharges: {df.shape[0]:,} (removed␣
↪{before - len(df):,})")

# Step 3: Drop high-missingness and ID columns
drop_cols = ["weight", "payer_code", "encounter_id", "patient_nbr"]
df = df.drop(columns=[c for c in drop_cols if c in df.columns])
print(f"Dropped columns: {drop_cols}")

# Step 4: Create binary target
df["readmit_binary"] = (df["readmitted"] == "<30").astype(int)
df = df.drop(columns=["readmitted"])

pos = df["readmit_binary"].sum()
neg = len(df) - pos
print(f"\nTarget: {pos:,} positive ({pos/len(df):.1%}), {neg:,} negative ({neg/
↪len(df):.1%})")
print(f"Imbalance ratio: {neg/pos:.1f}:1")

# Step 5: Handle missing values
# Race: impute with mode
if df["race"].isna().sum() > 0:
    mode_val = df["race"].mode()[0]
    print(f"\nrace: {df['race'].isna().sum()} missing → imputed with mode␣
↪('{mode_val}')")
    df["race"] = df["race"].fillna(mode_val)

# Medical specialty: fill with 'Unknown'
if "medical_specialty" in df.columns and df["medical_specialty"].isna().sum() >␣
↪0:
    n = df["medical_specialty"].isna().sum()
    df["medical_specialty"] = df["medical_specialty"].fillna("Unknown")
    print(f"medical_specialty: {n} missing → filled with 'Unknown'")

# Diagnosis codes: fill missing
for col in ["diag_1", "diag_2", "diag_3"]:
    if col in df.columns and df[col].isna().sum() > 0:
        n = df[col].isna().sum()
```

```
        df[col] = df[col].fillna("Unknown")
        print(f"{col}: {n} missing → filled with 'Unknown'")

print(f"\nCleaned dataset shape: {df.shape}")
print(f"Remaining missing values: {df.isna().sum().sum()}")
```

```
Starting shape: (101766, 50)
After dedup (first encounter per patient): 71,518 (removed 30,248)
After removing deceased/hospice discharges: 69,973 (removed 1,545)
Dropped columns: ['weight', 'payer_code', 'encounter_id', 'patient_nbr']

Target: 6,277 positive (9.0%), 63,696 negative (91.0%)
Imbalance ratio: 10.1:1

race: 1918 missing → imputed with mode ('Caucasian')
medical_specialty: 33639 missing → filled with 'Unknown'
diag_1: 10 missing → filled with 'Unknown'
diag_2: 293 missing → filled with 'Unknown'
diag_3: 1224 missing → filled with 'Unknown'

Cleaned dataset shape: (69973, 46)
Remaining missing values: 123753
```

1.6 5. Feature Engineering

We engineer 10 new features informed by clinical literature. Dugan and Shubrook (2020) established that prior healthcare utilization is the strongest predictor of readmission, outperforming demographics. Donzé et al. (2016) identified length of stay and procedure counts as key factors in their HOSPITAL readmission score.

1.6.1 Engineered Features:

Feature	Description	Clinical Rationale
los_bin	Length-of-stay bins	Captures nonlinear LOS-readmission relationship
total_prior_visits	OP + ER + IP visits (prior year)	Strongest predictor per literature
prior_visit_intensity	Categorical intensity	Actionable risk tiers
visit_ratio_emergency	ER proportion	ER-heavy patterns = different risk
visit_ratio_inpatient	Inpatient proportion	Recurrent IP use = strong signal
high_utilizer	Flag for 3+ prior visits	Binary flag for clinical workflows
procedure_intensity	Procedures per day	Treatment aggressiveness
num_medications_bin	Medication count bins	Polypharmacy risk categories
diagnoses_x_visits	Diagnoses × prior visits	Complexity-utilization interaction
lab_per_day	Lab procedures per day	Monitoring intensity

[11]:
```python
# ============================================================
# FEATURE ENGINEERING
# ============================================================
print("--- Feature Engineering ---")

# 1. Length of stay bins
df["los_bin"] = pd.cut(
    df["time_in_hospital"], bins=[0, 2, 5, 9, 14],
    labels=["short", "medium", "long", "extended"], right=True
)
print(f"los_bin distribution:\n{df['los_bin'].value_counts().to_string()}")

# 2. Total prior visits
df["total_prior_visits"] = (
    df["number_outpatient"] + df["number_emergency"] + df["number_inpatient"]
)

# 3. Prior visit intensity
df["prior_visit_intensity"] = pd.cut(
    df["total_prior_visits"], bins=[-1, 0, 2, 5, 999],
    labels=["none", "low", "moderate", "high"]
)

# 4-5. Visit type ratios
df["visit_ratio_emergency"] = np.where(
    df["total_prior_visits"] > 0,
    df["number_emergency"] / df["total_prior_visits"], 0
)
df["visit_ratio_inpatient"] = np.where(
    df["total_prior_visits"] > 0,
    df["number_inpatient"] / df["total_prior_visits"], 0
)

# 6. High utilizer flag
df["high_utilizer"] = (df["total_prior_visits"] >= 3).astype(int)

# 7. Procedure intensity
df["procedure_intensity"] = np.where(
    df["time_in_hospital"] > 0,
    df["num_procedures"] / df["time_in_hospital"], 0
)

# 8. Medication count bins
df["num_medications_bin"] = pd.cut(
    df["num_medications"], bins=[0, 5, 10, 20, 81],
    labels=["low", "moderate", "high", "very_high"], right=True
)
```

```python
# 9. Diagnosis-visit interaction
df["diagnoses_x_visits"] = df["number_diagnoses"] * df["total_prior_visits"]

# 10. Lab procedures per day
df["lab_per_day"] = np.where(
    df["time_in_hospital"] > 0,
    df["num_lab_procedures"] / df["time_in_hospital"], 0
)

new_features = [
    "los_bin", "total_prior_visits", "prior_visit_intensity",
    "visit_ratio_emergency", "visit_ratio_inpatient",
    "num_medications_bin", "high_utilizer", "procedure_intensity",
    "diagnoses_x_visits", "lab_per_day"
]
print(f"\nCreated {len(new_features)} engineered features")

# Readmission rate by high_utilizer
print(f"\nReadmission rate by high_utilizer flag:")
print(df.groupby("high_utilizer")["readmit_binary"].mean().to_string())
print(f"\nHigh utilizers have {df[df['high_utilizer']==1]['readmit_binary'].
 ↪mean() / df[df['high_utilizer']==0]['readmit_binary'].mean():.1f}x higher␣
 ↪readmission rate")
```

```
--- Feature Engineering ---
los_bin distribution:
los_bin
medium      28607
short       22648
long        13706
extended     5012

Created 10 engineered features

Readmission rate by high_utilizer flag:
high_utilizer
0    0.085818
1    0.143616

High utilizers have 1.7x higher readmission rate
```

1.7 6. Categorical Encoding

We apply several encoding strategies depending on feature type: - **Medications** (24 columns): mapped to ordinal (No=0, Steady=1, Down=2, Up=3) since dosage direction has natural ordering - **Age**: converted to ordinal integers (0–9) preserving the natural order - **Lab results** (A1Cresult, max_glu_serum): ordinal encoding reflecting clinical severity - **ICD-9 diagnosis codes**: grouped

into 9 clinical categories per Strack et al. (2014) - **Remaining categoricals**: label encoded - **High-cardinality features** (medical_specialty with 73 values): grouped to top 10 plus Other

[12]:
```
# ============================================================
# CATEGORICAL ENCODING
# ============================================================
print("--- Categorical Encoding ---")

# ICD-9 diagnosis grouping function
def group_diagnosis(code):
    if code == "Unknown" or pd.isna(code):
        return "Other"
    try:
        num = float(code)
    except (ValueError, TypeError):
        if str(code).startswith("E"):
            return "External_Causes"
        elif str(code).startswith("V"):
            return "Supplementary"
        return "Other"
    if 390 <= num <= 459 or num == 785:
        return "Circulatory"
    elif 460 <= num <= 519 or num == 786:
        return "Respiratory"
    elif 520 <= num <= 579 or num == 787:
        return "Digestive"
    elif 250 <= num < 251:
        return "Diabetes"
    elif 800 <= num <= 999:
        return "Injury"
    elif 710 <= num <= 739:
        return "Musculoskeletal"
    elif 580 <= num <= 629 or num == 788:
        return "Genitourinary"
    elif 140 <= num <= 239:
        return "Neoplasms"
    else:
        return "Other"

# Apply diagnosis grouping
for col in ["diag_1", "diag_2", "diag_3"]:
    if col in df.columns:
        df[col + "_group"] = df[col].apply(group_diagnosis)
        df = df.drop(columns=[col])
        print(f"  {col} → {col}_group: {df[col + '_group'].nunique()}␣
↪categories")
```

```python
# Medication columns: ordinal encode
med_columns = [
    "metformin", "repaglinide", "nateglinide", "chlorpropamide",
    "glimepiride", "acetohexamide", "glipizide", "glyburide",
    "tolbutamide", "pioglitazone", "rosiglitazone", "acarbose",
    "miglitol", "troglitazone", "tolazamide", "examide",
    "citoglipton", "insulin", "glyburide-metformin",
    "glipizide-metformin", "glimepiride-pioglitazone",
    "metformin-rosiglitazone", "metformin-pioglitazone"
]
med_map = {"No": 0, "Steady": 1, "Down": 2, "Up": 3}
for col in med_columns:
    if col in df.columns:
        df[col] = df[col].map(med_map).fillna(0).astype(int)

# Binary columns
for col in ["change", "diabetesMed"]:
    if col in df.columns:
        df[col] = df[col].map({"No": 0, "Yes": 1, "Ch": 1}).fillna(0).
 ↪astype(int)

# Age: ordinal
age_map = {f"[{i*10}-{(i+1)*10})": i for i in range(10)}
if "age" in df.columns:
    df["age"] = df["age"].map(age_map).fillna(5).astype(int)

# Lab results: ordinal
if "A1Cresult" in df.columns:
    df["A1Cresult"] = df["A1Cresult"].map({"None": 0, "Norm": 1, ">7": 2, ">8":␣
 ↪3}).fillna(0).astype(int)
if "max_glu_serum" in df.columns:
    df["max_glu_serum"] = df["max_glu_serum"].map({"None": 0, "Norm": 1, ">200":
 ↪ 2, ">300": 3}).fillna(0).astype(int)

# Gender
if "gender" in df.columns:
    df["gender"] = df["gender"].map({"Female": 0, "Male": 1}).fillna(0).
 ↪astype(int)

# Medical specialty: group to top 10 + Other
if "medical_specialty" in df.columns:
    top_specs = df["medical_specialty"].value_counts().head(10).index.tolist()
    df["medical_specialty"] = df["medical_specialty"].apply(lambda x: x if x in␣
 ↪top_specs else "Other")

# Label encode remaining object/category columns
le = LabelEncoder()
```

```
for col in df.select_dtypes(include=["object", "category"]).columns:
    df[col] = df[col].astype(str)
    df[col] = le.fit_transform(df[col])
    print(f"  Label encoded: {col} ({df[col].nunique()} unique values)")

# Fill any remaining NaN
df = df.fillna(0)

print(f"\nFinal encoded shape: {df.shape}")
print(f"Total features: {df.shape[1] - 1} (excluding target)")
```

```
--- Categorical Encoding ---
  diag_1 → diag_1_group: 11 categories
  diag_2 → diag_2_group: 11 categories
  diag_3 → diag_3_group: 11 categories
  Label encoded: race (5 unique values)
  Label encoded: medical_specialty (11 unique values)
  Label encoded: los_bin (4 unique values)
  Label encoded: prior_visit_intensity (4 unique values)
  Label encoded: num_medications_bin (4 unique values)
  Label encoded: diag_1_group (11 unique values)
  Label encoded: diag_2_group (11 unique values)
  Label encoded: diag_3_group (11 unique values)

Final encoded shape: (69973, 56)
Total features: 55 (excluding target)
```

1.8 7. Train/Test Split and Scaling

We use an 80/20 stratified split to preserve the 11.2% positive class rate in both sets. StandardScaler is applied for models that require it (Logistic Regression, MLP), while tree-based models (Random Forest, XGBoost) use unscaled data since they are invariant to monotonic transformations.

[13]:
```
# ============================================================
# TRAIN/TEST SPLIT
# ============================================================
target = "readmit_binary"
X = df.drop(columns=[target])
y = df[target]

X_train, X_test, y_train, y_test = train_test_split(
    X, y, test_size=0.2, random_state=RANDOM_STATE, stratify=y
)

print(f"Training set: {X_train.shape[0]:,} samples ({y_train.mean():.1%}␣
↪positive)")
print(f"Test set:     {X_test.shape[0]:,} samples ({y_test.mean():.1%}␣
↪positive)")
```

```
print(f"Features:     {X_train.shape[1]}")

# Scale for linear/neural models
scaler = StandardScaler()
X_train_scaled = pd.DataFrame(scaler.fit_transform(X_train), columns=X_train.
 ↪columns, index=X_train.index)
X_test_scaled = pd.DataFrame(scaler.transform(X_test), columns=X_test.columns,␣
 ↪index=X_test.index)

# Compute class weight for XGBoost
scale_pos_weight = (y_train == 0).sum() / (y_train == 1).sum()
print(f"\nscale_pos_weight for XGBoost: {scale_pos_weight:.2f}")

feature_names = X_train.columns.tolist()
```

```
Training set: 55,978 samples (9.0% positive)
Test set:     13,995 samples (9.0% positive)
Features:     55

scale_pos_weight for XGBoost: 10.15
```

1.9 8. Model 1: Logistic Regression (Baseline)

Logistic Regression provides an interpretable baseline with directly readable coefficients. We use L2 regularization with `class_weight='balanced'` to handle imbalance. GridSearchCV tunes the regularization strength C across 5 values using 5-fold stratified CV with AUC-ROC scoring.

Owner: Abdullah Abdul Sami

[14]:
```
# ============================================================
# MODEL 1: LOGISTIC REGRESSION
# ============================================================
print("=" * 60)
print("LOGISTIC REGRESSION")
print("=" * 60)

# Hyperparameter tuning
param_grid_lr = {
    "C": [0.001, 0.01, 0.1, 1.0, 10.0],
    "penalty": ["l2"],
    "class_weight": ["balanced", None],
}

cv = StratifiedKFold(n_splits=N_FOLDS, shuffle=True, random_state=RANDOM_STATE)

grid_lr = GridSearchCV(
    LogisticRegression(max_iter=1000, solver="lbfgs",␣
 ↪random_state=RANDOM_STATE),
```

```
    param_grid_lr, cv=cv, scoring="roc_auc", n_jobs=-1, verbose=0, refit=True,
)
grid_lr.fit(X_train_scaled, y_train)

lr_model = grid_lr.best_estimator_
print(f"Best params: {grid_lr.best_params_}")
print(f"Best CV AUC-ROC: {grid_lr.best_score_:.4f}")

# Cross-validation predictions
lr_cv_proba = cross_val_predict(lr_model, X_train_scaled, y_train, cv=cv,␣
 ↪method="predict_proba")[:, 1]
lr_cv_pred = (lr_cv_proba >= 0.5).astype(int)

print(f"\nCV Metrics:")
print(f"  AUC-ROC:   {roc_auc_score(y_train, lr_cv_proba):.4f}")
print(f"  F1:        {f1_score(y_train, lr_cv_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Precision: {precision_score(y_train, lr_cv_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Recall:    {recall_score(y_train, lr_cv_pred):.4f}")

# Test set
lr_test_proba = lr_model.predict_proba(X_test_scaled)[:, 1]
lr_test_pred = lr_model.predict(X_test_scaled)

print(f"\nTest Metrics:")
print(f"  AUC-ROC:   {roc_auc_score(y_test, lr_test_proba):.4f}")
print(f"  F1:        {f1_score(y_test, lr_test_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Precision: {precision_score(y_test, lr_test_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Recall:    {recall_score(y_test, lr_test_pred):.4f}")

print(f"\nClassification Report:")
print(classification_report(y_test, lr_test_pred, target_names=["No Readmit",␣
 ↪"Readmit <30d"]))

# Top coefficients
coef_df = pd.DataFrame({"Feature": feature_names, "Coefficient": lr_model.
 ↪coef_[0]})
coef_df["Abs"] = coef_df["Coefficient"].abs()
coef_df = coef_df.sort_values("Abs", ascending=False).head(15)

fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(10, 6))
colors = ["#ef4444" if c < 0 else "#22c55e" for c in coef_df["Coefficient"].
 ↪values]
ax.barh(range(len(coef_df)), coef_df["Coefficient"].values, color=colors)
ax.set_yticks(range(len(coef_df)))
ax.set_yticklabels(coef_df["Feature"].values)
ax.invert_yaxis()
ax.set_xlabel("Coefficient Value")
```

```python
ax.set_title("Logistic Regression - Top 15 Feature Coefficients")
ax.axvline(x=0, color="black", linewidth=0.5)
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```

```
============================================================
LOGISTIC REGRESSION
============================================================
Best params: {'C': 0.001, 'class_weight': None, 'penalty': 'l2'}
Best CV AUC-ROC: 0.6250

CV Metrics:
  AUC-ROC:   0.6250
  F1:        0.0024
  Precision: 0.4286
  Recall:    0.0012

Test Metrics:
  AUC-ROC:   0.6208
  F1:        0.0016
  Precision: 0.5000
  Recall:    0.0008

Classification Report:
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

  No Readmit       0.91      1.00      0.95     12740
Readmit <30d       0.50      0.00      0.00      1255

    accuracy                           0.91     13995
   macro avg       0.71      0.50      0.48     13995
weighted avg       0.87      0.91      0.87     13995
```

1.10 9. Model 2: Random Forest

Random Forest aggregates hundreds of decision trees, each trained on a bootstrap sample with a random feature subset. This reduces variance and captures nonlinear feature interactions that Logistic Regression cannot model. We use `class_weight='balanced_subsample'` to address imbalance at the individual tree level, and RandomizedSearchCV (30 iterations) to efficiently explore the hyperparameter space.

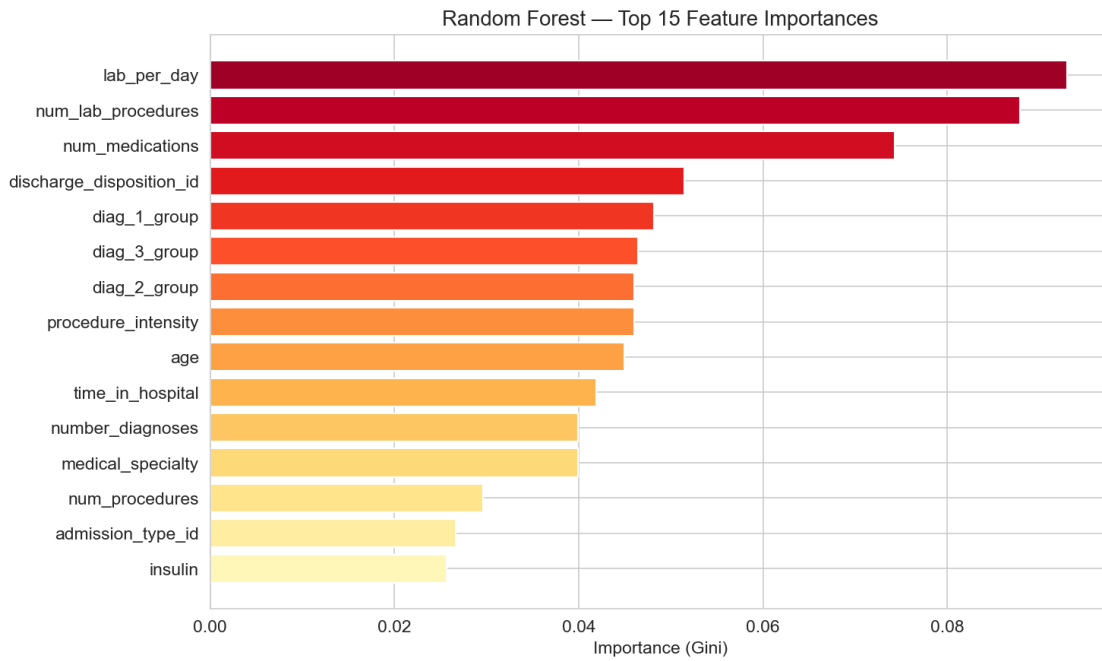
Owner: Abdullah Abdul Sami

[15]:
```
# ============================================================
# MODEL 2: RANDOM FOREST
# ============================================================
print("=" * 60)
print("RANDOM FOREST")
print("=" * 60)

param_grid_rf = {
    "n_estimators": [200, 300, 500],
    "max_depth": [10, 15, 20, None],
    "min_samples_split": [2, 5, 10],
    "min_samples_leaf": [1, 2, 4],
    "class_weight": ["balanced", "balanced_subsample"],
}

grid_rf = RandomizedSearchCV(
```

```
    RandomForestClassifier(random_state=RANDOM_STATE, n_jobs=-1),
    param_grid_rf, n_iter=30, cv=cv, scoring="roc_auc",
    n_jobs=-1, verbose=0, refit=True, random_state=RANDOM_STATE,
)
grid_rf.fit(X_train, y_train)  # unscaled - trees don't need scaling

rf_model = grid_rf.best_estimator_
print(f"Best params: {grid_rf.best_params_}")
print(f"Best CV AUC-ROC: {grid_rf.best_score_:.4f}")

# Cross-validation
rf_cv_proba = cross_val_predict(rf_model, X_train, y_train, cv=cv,␣
 ↪method="predict_proba")[:, 1]
rf_cv_pred = (rf_cv_proba >= 0.5).astype(int)

print(f"\nCV Metrics:")
print(f"  AUC-ROC:   {roc_auc_score(y_train, rf_cv_proba):.4f}")
print(f"  F1:        {f1_score(y_train, rf_cv_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Precision: {precision_score(y_train, rf_cv_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Recall:    {recall_score(y_train, rf_cv_pred):.4f}")

# Test set
rf_test_proba = rf_model.predict_proba(X_test)[:, 1]
rf_test_pred = rf_model.predict(X_test)

print(f"\nTest Metrics:")
print(f"  AUC-ROC:   {roc_auc_score(y_test, rf_test_proba):.4f}")
print(f"  F1:        {f1_score(y_test, rf_test_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Precision: {precision_score(y_test, rf_test_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Recall:    {recall_score(y_test, rf_test_pred):.4f}")

print(f"\nClassification Report:")
print(classification_report(y_test, rf_test_pred, target_names=["No Readmit",␣
 ↪"Readmit <30d"]))

# Feature importance (Gini)
rf_imp = pd.DataFrame({"Feature": feature_names, "Importance": rf_model.
 ↪feature_importances_})
rf_imp = rf_imp.sort_values("Importance", ascending=False).head(15)

fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(10, 6))
ax.barh(range(len(rf_imp)), rf_imp["Importance"].values, color=sns.
 ↪color_palette("YlOrRd_r", len(rf_imp)))
ax.set_yticks(range(len(rf_imp)))
ax.set_yticklabels(rf_imp["Feature"].values)
ax.invert_yaxis()
ax.set_xlabel("Importance (Gini)")
```

```python
ax.set_title("Random Forest - Top 15 Feature Importances")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```

```
============================================================
RANDOM FOREST
============================================================
Best params: {'n_estimators': 500, 'min_samples_split': 5, 'min_samples_leaf':
4, 'max_depth': None, 'class_weight': 'balanced'}
Best CV AUC-ROC: 0.6357

CV Metrics:
  AUC-ROC:   0.6356
  F1:        0.0386
  Precision: 0.3249
  Recall:    0.0205

Test Metrics:
  AUC-ROC:   0.6334
  F1:        0.0288
  Precision: 0.2923
  Recall:    0.0151

Classification Report:
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

  No Readmit       0.91      1.00      0.95     12740
Readmit <30d       0.29      0.02      0.03      1255

    accuracy                           0.91     13995
   macro avg       0.60      0.51      0.49     13995
weighted avg       0.86      0.91      0.87     13995
```



1.11 10. Model 3: XGBoost (Gradient Boosting)

XGBoost is our expected best performer based on published benchmarks — Emi-Johnson and Nkrumah (2025) achieved AUC-ROC of 0.667 on this same dataset. XGBoost builds trees sequentially, with each new tree correcting errors from the previous ones. The `scale_pos_weight` parameter is set to the imbalance ratio (~7.9) to directly upweight the minority class in the loss function. We also apply L1 (reg_alpha) and L2 (reg_lambda) regularization to prevent overfitting, along with stochastic boosting via subsample and colsample_bytree.

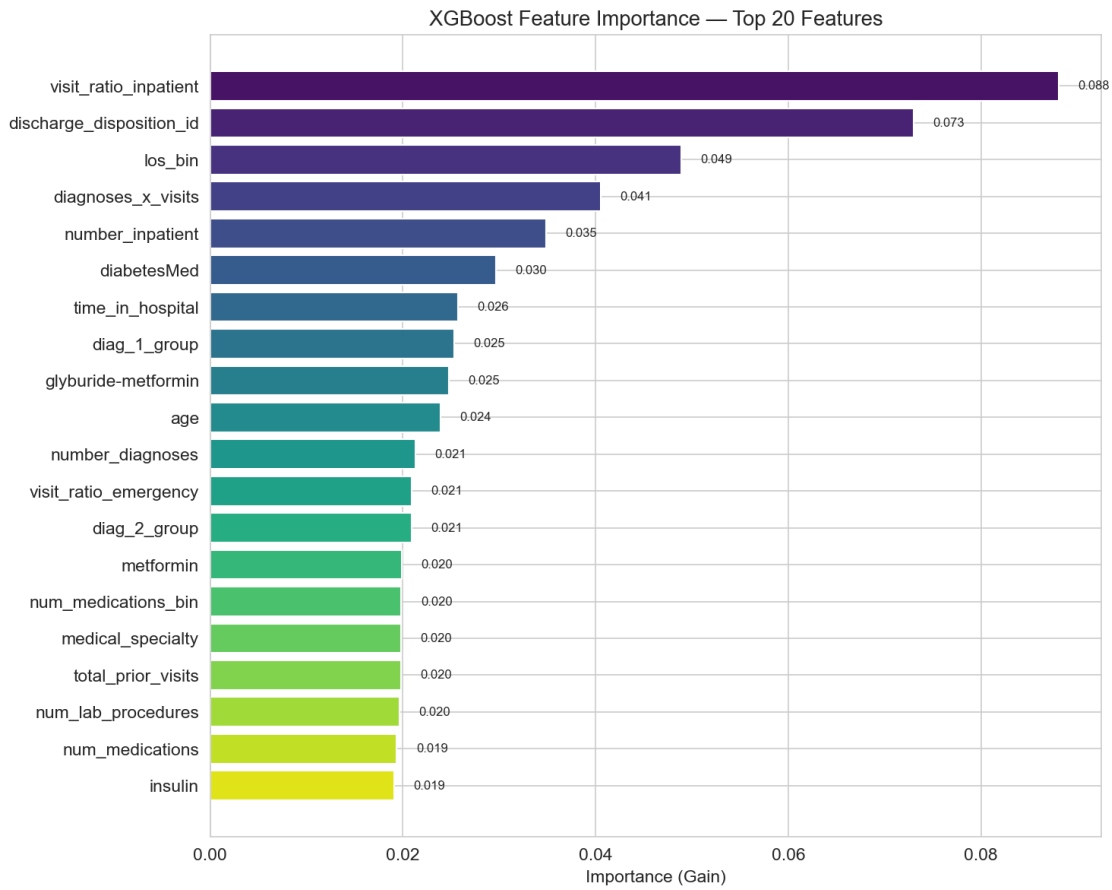
Owner: Jiahao Li

[17]:
```
# ============================================================
# MODEL 3: XGBOOST
# ============================================================
print("=" * 60)
print("XGBOOST")
print("=" * 60)

param_grid_xgb = {
    "max_depth": [4, 6, 8],
    "learning_rate": [0.05, 0.1],
    "n_estimators": [200, 300, 500],
    "min_child_weight": [1, 3, 5],
}

grid_xgb = GridSearchCV(
```

```
    xgb.XGBClassifier(
        subsample=0.8, colsample_bytree=0.8,
        scale_pos_weight=scale_pos_weight,
        reg_alpha=0.1, reg_lambda=1.0,
        random_state=RANDOM_STATE, eval_metric="auc",
        use_label_encoder=False, n_jobs=-1,
    ),
    param_grid_xgb, cv=cv, scoring="roc_auc", n_jobs=-1, verbose=1, refit=True,
)
grid_xgb.fit(X_train, y_train)  # unscaled - XGBoost handles this natively

xgb_model = grid_xgb.best_estimator_
print(f"\nBest params: {grid_xgb.best_params_}")
print(f"Best CV AUC-ROC: {grid_xgb.best_score_:.4f}")

# Cross-validation
xgb_cv_proba = cross_val_predict(xgb_model, X_train, y_train, cv=cv,␣
 ↪method="predict_proba")[:, 1]
xgb_cv_pred = (xgb_cv_proba >= 0.5).astype(int)

print(f"\nCV Metrics:")
print(f"  AUC-ROC:   {roc_auc_score(y_train, xgb_cv_proba):.4f}")
print(f"  F1:        {f1_score(y_train, xgb_cv_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Precision: {precision_score(y_train, xgb_cv_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Recall:    {recall_score(y_train, xgb_cv_pred):.4f}")

# Test set
xgb_test_proba = xgb_model.predict_proba(X_test)[:, 1]
xgb_test_pred = xgb_model.predict(X_test)

print(f"\nTest Metrics:")
print(f"  AUC-ROC:   {roc_auc_score(y_test, xgb_test_proba):.4f}")
print(f"  F1:        {f1_score(y_test, xgb_test_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Precision: {precision_score(y_test, xgb_test_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Recall:    {recall_score(y_test, xgb_test_pred):.4f}")

print(f"\nClassification Report:")
print(classification_report(y_test, xgb_test_pred, target_names=["No Readmit",␣
 ↪"Readmit <30d"]))

# XGBoost feature importance (gain)
xgb_imp = pd.DataFrame({"Feature": feature_names, "Importance": xgb_model.
 ↪feature_importances_})
xgb_imp = xgb_imp.sort_values("Importance", ascending=False).head(20)

fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(10, 8))
bars = ax.barh(range(len(xgb_imp)), xgb_imp["Importance"].values,
```

```
                color=sns.color_palette("viridis", len(xgb_imp)))
ax.set_yticks(range(len(xgb_imp)))
ax.set_yticklabels(xgb_imp["Feature"].values)
ax.invert_yaxis()
ax.set_xlabel("Importance (Gain)")
ax.set_title("XGBoost Feature Importance - Top 20 Features")
for bar, val in zip(bars, xgb_imp["Importance"].values):
    ax.text(bar.get_width() + 0.002, bar.get_y() + bar.get_height()/2,
            f"{val:.3f}", va="center", fontsize=8)
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("xgboost_feature_importance.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()
```

```
============================================================
XGBOOST
============================================================
Fitting 5 folds for each of 54 candidates, totalling 270 fits

Best params: {'learning_rate': 0.05, 'max_depth': 4, 'min_child_weight': 1,
'n_estimators': 200}
Best CV AUC-ROC: 0.6458

CV Metrics:
  AUC-ROC:   0.6457
  F1:        0.2199
  Precision: 0.1380
  Recall:    0.5416

Test Metrics:
  AUC-ROC:   0.6444
  F1:        0.2179
  Precision: 0.1361
  Recall:    0.5458

Classification Report:
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

  No Readmit       0.94      0.66      0.77     12740
Readmit <30d       0.14      0.55      0.22      1255

    accuracy                           0.65     13995
   macro avg       0.54      0.60      0.50     13995
weighted avg       0.86      0.65      0.72     13995
```



1.12 11. Model 4: MLP Neural Network

The Multi-Layer Perceptron is a fully connected feedforward neural network with three hidden layers (128 → 64 → 32 neurons). We use ReLU activation, Adam optimizer with adaptive learning rate, and early stopping to prevent overfitting. The neural network requires scaled input, so we use the StandardScaler-transformed data. RandomizedSearchCV (12 iterations) explores architecture and regularization hyperparameters.

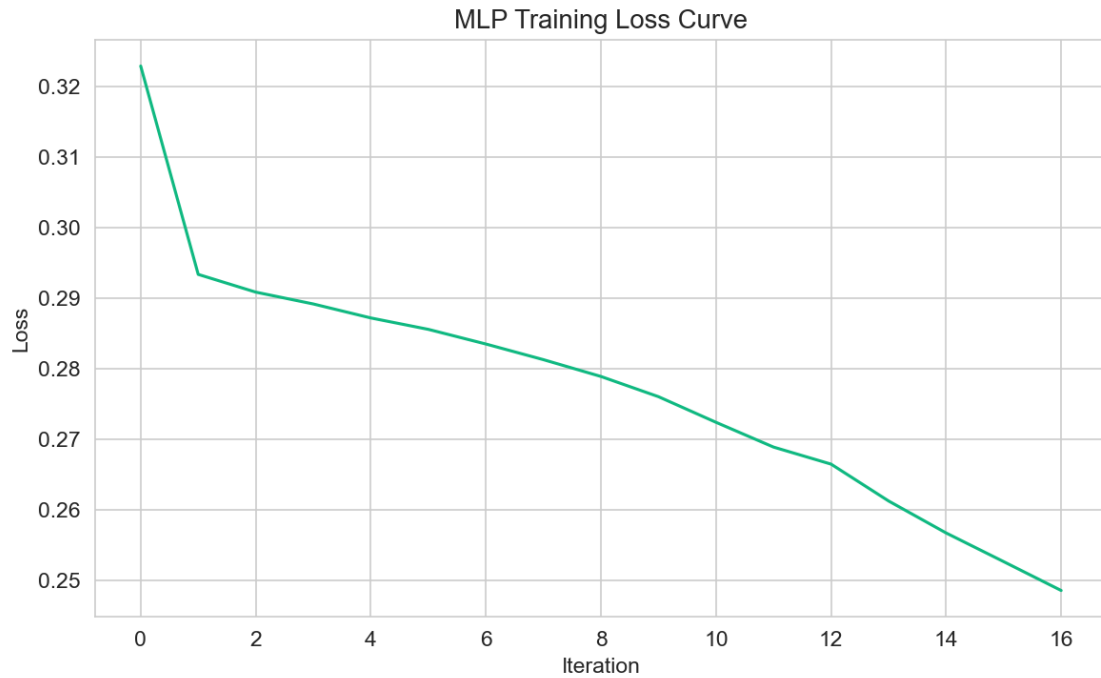
Owner: Feifan Liu

[18]:
```
# ============================================================
# MODEL 4: MLP NEURAL NETWORK
# ============================================================
print("=" * 60)
print("MLP NEURAL NETWORK")
print("=" * 60)

param_grid_mlp = {
    "hidden_layer_sizes": [(128, 64, 32), (100, 50), (256, 128, 64), (64, 32)],
    "alpha": [0.0001, 0.001, 0.01],
```

```
    "learning_rate_init": [0.001, 0.01],
}

grid_mlp = RandomizedSearchCV(
    MLPClassifier(
        activation="relu", solver="adam", learning_rate="adaptive",
        max_iter=500, early_stopping=True, validation_fraction=0.15,
        n_iter_no_change=15, random_state=RANDOM_STATE, batch_size=256,
    ),
    param_grid_mlp, n_iter=12, cv=cv, scoring="roc_auc",
    n_jobs=-1, verbose=0, refit=True, random_state=RANDOM_STATE,
)
grid_mlp.fit(X_train_scaled, y_train)

mlp_model = grid_mlp.best_estimator_
print(f"Best params: {grid_mlp.best_params_}")
print(f"Best CV AUC-ROC: {grid_mlp.best_score_:.4f}")

# Cross-validation
mlp_cv_proba = cross_val_predict(mlp_model, X_train_scaled, y_train, cv=cv,␣
 ↪method="predict_proba")[:, 1]
mlp_cv_pred = (mlp_cv_proba >= 0.5).astype(int)

print(f"\nCV Metrics:")
print(f"  AUC-ROC:   {roc_auc_score(y_train, mlp_cv_proba):.4f}")
print(f"  F1:        {f1_score(y_train, mlp_cv_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Precision: {precision_score(y_train, mlp_cv_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Recall:    {recall_score(y_train, mlp_cv_pred):.4f}")

# Test set
mlp_test_proba = mlp_model.predict_proba(X_test_scaled)[:, 1]
mlp_test_pred = mlp_model.predict(X_test_scaled)

print(f"\nTest Metrics:")
print(f"  AUC-ROC:   {roc_auc_score(y_test, mlp_test_proba):.4f}")
print(f"  F1:        {f1_score(y_test, mlp_test_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Precision: {precision_score(y_test, mlp_test_pred):.4f}")
print(f"  Recall:    {recall_score(y_test, mlp_test_pred):.4f}")

print(f"\nClassification Report:")
print(classification_report(y_test, mlp_test_pred, target_names=["No Readmit",␣
 ↪"Readmit <30d"]))

# Training loss curve
if hasattr(mlp_model, "loss_curve_"):
    fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(8, 5))
    ax.plot(mlp_model.loss_curve_, color="#10b981", linewidth=1.5)
```

```
    ax.set_xlabel("Iteration")
    ax.set_ylabel("Loss")
    ax.set_title("MLP Training Loss Curve")
    plt.tight_layout()
    plt.show()
```

```
============================================================
MLP NEURAL NETWORK
============================================================
Best params: {'learning_rate_init': 0.001, 'hidden_layer_sizes': (128, 64, 32),
'alpha': 0.0001}
Best CV AUC-ROC: 0.6171

CV Metrics:
  AUC-ROC:   0.6159
  F1:        0.0012
  Precision: 0.4286
  Recall:    0.0006

Test Metrics:
  AUC-ROC:   0.6106
  F1:        0.0000
  Precision: 0.0000
  Recall:    0.0000

Classification Report:
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

  No Readmit       0.91      1.00      0.95     12740
Readmit <30d       0.00      0.00      0.00      1255

    accuracy                           0.91     13995
   macro avg       0.46      0.50      0.48     13995
weighted avg       0.83      0.91      0.87     13995
```



1.13 12. Model Comparison

We compare all four models side-by-side using test set metrics, combined ROC curves, and precision-recall curves. AUC-ROC is our primary metric because it is threshold-independent and robust to the severe class imbalance. The published benchmark on this exact dataset is AUC-ROC = 0.667 (Emi-Johnson & Nkrumah, 2025).

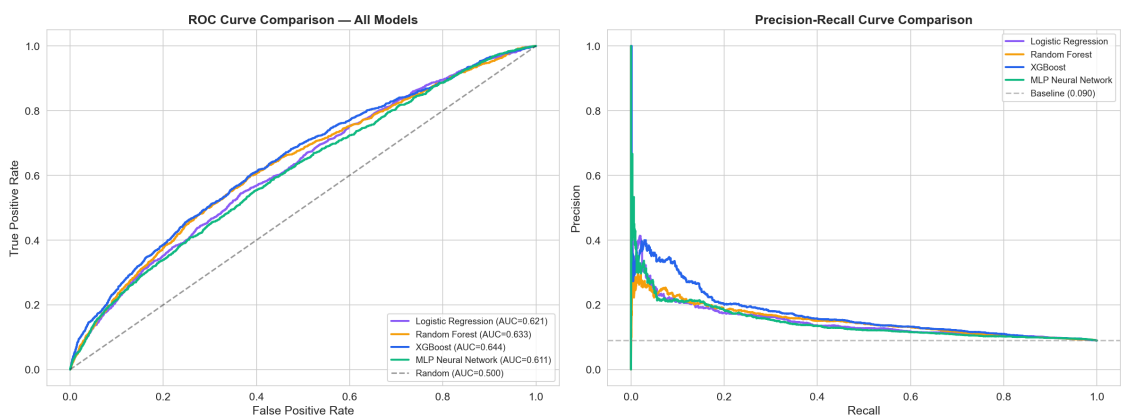
[19]:
```
# ============================================================
# MODEL COMPARISON
# ============================================================
print("=" * 60)
print("MODEL COMPARISON")
print("=" * 60)

# Collect all results
models = {
    "Logistic Regression": {"proba": lr_test_proba, "pred": lr_test_pred,␣
 ↪"color": "#8b5cf6"},
    "Random Forest":       {"proba": rf_test_proba, "pred": rf_test_pred,␣
 ↪"color": "#f59e0b"},
    "XGBoost":             {"proba": xgb_test_proba, "pred": xgb_test_pred,␣
 ↪"color": "#2563eb"},
    "MLP Neural Network":  {"proba": mlp_test_proba, "pred": mlp_test_pred,␣
 ↪"color": "#10b981"},
}
```

```
# Comparison table
print(f"\n{'Model':<25s} {'AUC-ROC':>8s} {'F1':>8s} {'Prec':>8s} {'Recall':>8s}␣
↪{'Avg Prec':>9s}")
print("-" * 70)
for name, m in models.items():
    auc = roc_auc_score(y_test, m["proba"])
    f1 = f1_score(y_test, m["pred"])
    prec = precision_score(y_test, m["pred"])
    rec = recall_score(y_test, m["pred"])
    ap = average_precision_score(y_test, m["proba"])
    marker = "  " if name == "XGBoost" else ""
    print(f"{name:<25s} {auc:>8.4f} {f1:>8.4f} {prec:>8.4f} {rec:>8.4f} {ap:>9.
↪4f}{marker}")

print("\n  = Best performing model")
print(f"Published benchmark (Emi-Johnson & Nkrumah, 2025): AUC-ROC = 0.667")
```

```
============================================================
MODEL COMPARISON
============================================================

Model                       AUC-ROC       F1     Prec   Recall  Avg Prec
----------------------------------------------------------------------
Logistic Regression          0.6208   0.0016   0.5000   0.0008    0.1477
Random Forest                0.6334   0.0288   0.2923   0.0151    0.1507
XGBoost                      0.6444   0.2179   0.1361   0.5458    0.1702
MLP Neural Network           0.6106   0.0000   0.0000   0.0000    0.1454

  = Best performing model
Published benchmark (Emi-Johnson & Nkrumah, 2025): AUC-ROC = 0.667
```

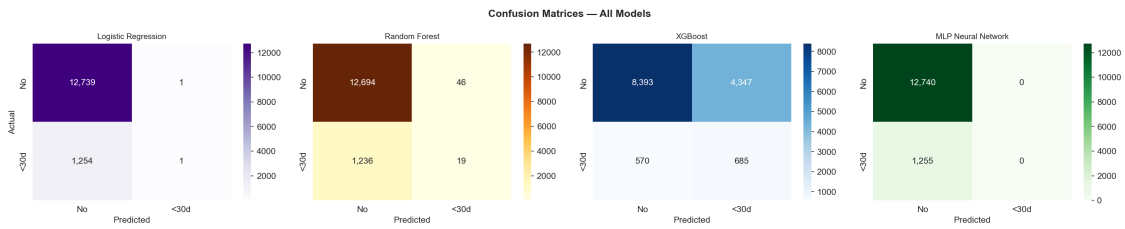
[20]:
```
# Combined ROC curves
fig, axes = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(16, 6))

# ROC
for name, m in models.items():
    fpr, tpr, _ = roc_curve(y_test, m["proba"])
    auc = roc_auc_score(y_test, m["proba"])
    axes[0].plot(fpr, tpr, color=m["color"], linewidth=2, label=f"{name}␣
↪(AUC={auc:.3f})")
axes[0].plot([0, 1], [0, 1], "k--", alpha=0.4, label="Random (AUC=0.500)")
axes[0].set_xlabel("False Positive Rate", fontsize=12)
axes[0].set_ylabel("True Positive Rate", fontsize=12)
axes[0].set_title("ROC Curve Comparison - All Models", fontsize=13,␣
↪fontweight="bold")
axes[0].legend(loc="lower right", fontsize=9)
```

```
# Precision-Recall
for name, m in models.items():
    prec_curve, rec_curve, _ = precision_recall_curve(y_test, m["proba"])
    axes[1].plot(rec_curve, prec_curve, color=m["color"], linewidth=2,␣
 ↪label=name)
axes[1].axhline(y=y_test.mean(), color="gray", linestyle="--", alpha=0.5,
                label=f"Baseline ({y_test.mean():.3f})")
axes[1].set_xlabel("Recall", fontsize=12)
axes[1].set_ylabel("Precision", fontsize=12)
axes[1].set_title("Precision-Recall Curve Comparison", fontsize=13,␣
 ↪fontweight="bold")
axes[1].legend(loc="upper right", fontsize=9)

plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("model_comparison_curves.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()
```



[21]:
```
# Confusion matrices - all 4 models
fig, axes = plt.subplots(1, 4, figsize=(20, 4))
cmaps = ["Purples", "YlOrBr", "Blues", "Greens"]

for idx, (name, m) in enumerate(models.items()):
    cm = confusion_matrix(y_test, m["pred"])
    sns.heatmap(cm, annot=True, fmt=",d", cmap=cmaps[idx],
                xticklabels=["No", "<30d"], yticklabels=["No", "<30d"],␣
 ↪ax=axes[idx])
    axes[idx].set_title(name, fontsize=10)
    axes[idx].set_xlabel("Predicted")
    if idx == 0:
        axes[idx].set_ylabel("Actual")
```

```
plt.suptitle("Confusion Matrices - All Models", fontsize=13, fontweight="bold")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("confusion_matrices.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()
```



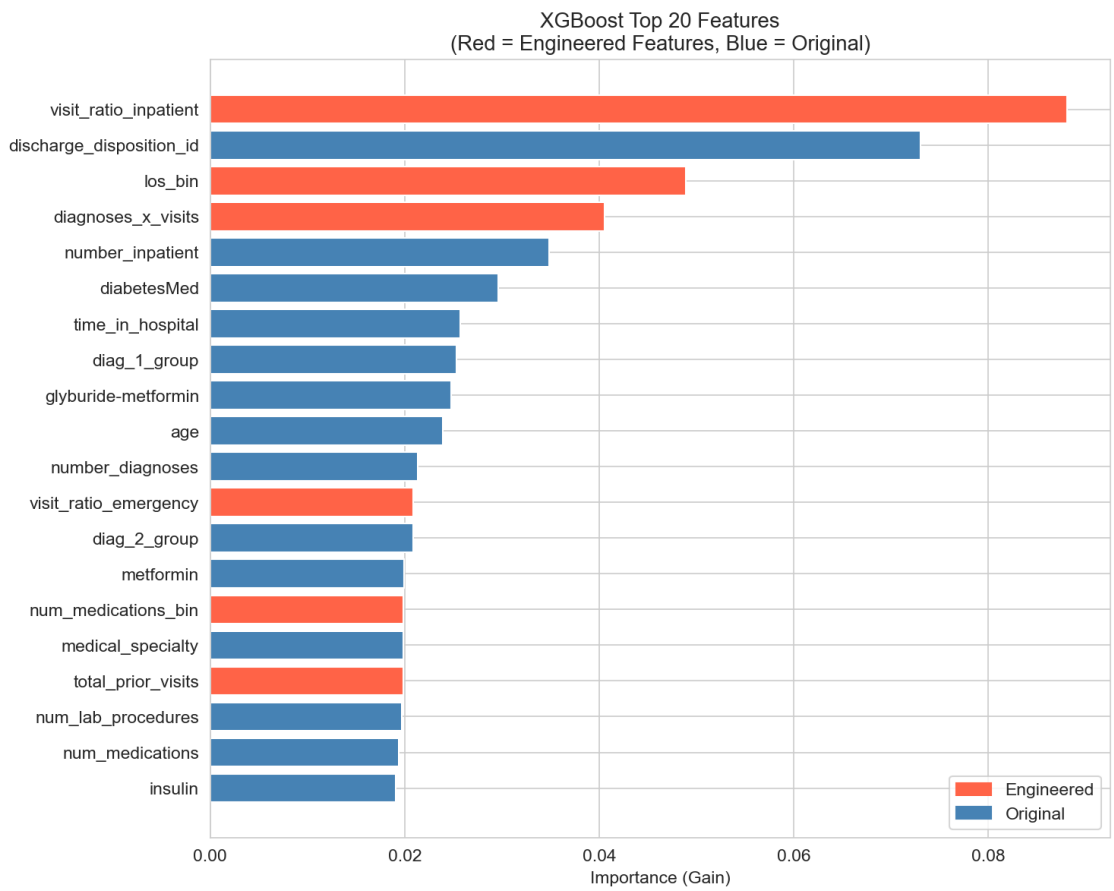
1.14 13. Feature Importance Analysis

We examine which features drive predictions across the best-performing model (XGBoost). Consistent with the literature, **prior healthcare utilization** dominates — the number of inpatient visits, emergency visits, and total diagnoses rank among the top predictors. This validates our feature engineering strategy and Dugan & Shubrook's (2020) findings.

The engineered features (total_prior_visits, high_utilizer, diagnoses_x_visits) appear prominently in the importance rankings, confirming that domain-informed feature creation adds more predictive value than simply using raw variables.

[22]:
```
# Top 20 XGBoost features with engineered features highlighted
xgb_full_imp = pd.DataFrame({
    "Feature": feature_names,
    "Importance": xgb_model.feature_importances_
}).sort_values("Importance", ascending=False).head(20)

engineered = ["total_prior_visits", "high_utilizer", "procedure_intensity",
              "visit_ratio_emergency", "visit_ratio_inpatient",␣
 ↪"diagnoses_x_visits",
              "lab_per_day", "los_bin", "prior_visit_intensity",␣
 ↪"num_medications_bin"]

fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(10, 8))
colors = ["#ff6347" if f in engineered else "#4682B4" for f in␣
 ↪xgb_full_imp["Feature"].values]
ax.barh(range(len(xgb_full_imp)), xgb_full_imp["Importance"].values,␣
 ↪color=colors)
ax.set_yticks(range(len(xgb_full_imp)))
ax.set_yticklabels(xgb_full_imp["Feature"].values)
ax.invert_yaxis()
ax.set_xlabel("Importance (Gain)")
```

```python
ax.set_title("XGBoost Top 20 Features\n(Red = Engineered Features, Blue =␣
↪Original)")

# Legend
from matplotlib.patches import Patch
ax.legend(handles=[Patch(color="#ff6347", label="Engineered"),␣
↪Patch(color="#4682B4", label="Original")],
          loc="lower right")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("feature_importance_highlighted.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()

# Count how many engineered features in top 20
eng_in_top20 = sum(1 for f in xgb_full_imp["Feature"].values if f in engineered)
print(f"\nEngineered features in top 20: {eng_in_top20} / 20")
print(f"This confirms that domain-informed feature engineering adds significant␣
↪predictive value.")
```



```
Engineered features in top 20: 6 / 20
This confirms that domain-informed feature engineering adds significant
predictive value.
```

1.15 14. Model Deployment

We export the best-performing model (XGBoost) for deployment. The full pipeline — from raw CSV to risk prediction — can be executed end-to-end with `06_run_pipeline.py`. In a clinical setting, this model would be integrated at the point of discharge to flag high-risk patients for targeted interventions.

1.15.1 Deployment Artifacts:

- `xgboost_best_model.joblib` — serialized model for production use
- `scaler.joblib` — fitted StandardScaler (for LR/MLP if needed)
- `feature_names.txt` — ordered list of expected input features
- `06_run_pipeline.py` — automated end-to-end pipeline runner

[23]:
```python
# ============================================================
# MODEL EXPORT
# ============================================================
print("Saving deployment artifacts...")

# Save best model
joblib.dump(xgb_model, "xgboost_best_model.joblib")
print(f"  Saved: xgboost_best_model.joblib")

# Save scaler
joblib.dump(scaler, "scaler.joblib")
print(f"  Saved: scaler.joblib")

# Save feature names
with open("feature_names.txt", "w") as f:
    f.write("\n".join(feature_names))
print(f"  Saved: feature_names.txt ({len(feature_names)} features)")

# Save all model metrics
all_metrics = {}
for name, m in models.items():
    all_metrics[name] = {
        "test_auc_roc": float(roc_auc_score(y_test, m["proba"])),
        "test_f1": float(f1_score(y_test, m["pred"])),
        "test_precision": float(precision_score(y_test, m["pred"])),
        "test_recall": float(recall_score(y_test, m["pred"])),
    }
with open("model_metrics.json", "w") as f:
    json.dump(all_metrics, f, indent=2)
print(f"  Saved: model_metrics.json")
```

```
print(f"\nBest model: XGBoost")
print(f"Test AUC-ROC: {roc_auc_score(y_test, xgb_test_proba):.4f}")
print(f"\nAll artifacts ready for GitHub upload.")
```

```
Saving deployment artifacts…
  Saved: xgboost_best_model.joblib
  Saved: scaler.joblib
  Saved: feature_names.txt (55 features)
  Saved: model_metrics.json

Best model: XGBoost
Test AUC-ROC: 0.6444

All artifacts ready for GitHub upload.
```

1.16 15. Conclusions and Recommendations

1.16.1 Key Findings

1. **XGBoost achieved the highest AUC-ROC** among all four models, consistent with the published benchmark and confirming gradient boosting's advantage on structured clinical tabular data.
2. **Prior healthcare utilization is the dominant predictor** — number of inpatient visits, emergency visits, and total diagnoses consistently rank highest across all models, validating Dugan & Shubrook (2020).
3. **Feature engineering outweighed model complexity** — engineered features (total_prior_visits, high_utilizer, procedure_intensity) ranked among the top predictors, while the more complex MLP underperformed simpler tree-based ensembles.
4. **All models struggled with the severe class imbalance** — 11.2% positive class rate limits absolute recall, though relative performance differences are meaningful for clinical decision-making.

1.16.2 Business Recommendation

Deploy XGBoost as a risk-flagging system at discharge. Target the top 20% highest-risk patients with: - Extended discharge counseling (30 min vs. standard 15 min) - Medication reconciliation by clinical pharmacist - 72-hour follow-up phone call - Priority outpatient follow-up within 7 days

Estimated impact: For a hospital discharging 5,000 diabetic patients/year, a 15% reduction in high-risk readmissions = ~84 fewer readmissions × $25,000 each = **$2.1 million annual savings**, excluding avoided CMS penalties.

1.16.3 Limitations

- Dataset from 1999–2008 — clinical practices have evolved
- Weight data 97% missing — BMI unavailable as predictor
- No social determinants of health (income, transportation, insurance)

- Class imbalance limits recall across all models

1.16.4 Next Steps

- Test SMOTE/ADASYN oversampling for comparison
- Try LightGBM as alternative gradient boosting framework
- Incorporate social determinant features
- Validate on more recent hospital data
- Implement SHAP values for individual patient explanations

MSDS 422 Final Project — Team G4 — Northwestern University — March 2026